

Jim Gillespie

Austin, TX | (512) 230-4673 | j3gillespie@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/jgilles](https://www.linkedin.com/in/jgilles) | j-gillespie.github.io/portfolio

SUMMARY

Senior Technical Writer with 20+ years of experience documenting complex software, hardware, and SaaS products. Proven track record collaborating with engineering, product, and UX teams in Agile environments to deliver accurate, structured documentation that accelerates product adoption and reduces support overhead. Experienced in Docs-as-Code workflows, OpenAPI/Swagger, DITA/XML, Markdown, and Git-based toolchains. Consistently recognized throughout my career for managing multiple projects in dynamic environments and delivering high-quality content under tight deadlines.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Writer | Independent Consultant | Austin, TX | Jan 2024–Present

- Conducted peer code reviews, providing clarity and usability feedback on developer-facing documentation.
- Upskilled through professional development courses, with emphasis on API documentation, AI, cloud computing, and data analysis.
- Completed multiple standalone projects; see selections listed in Recent Projects.

Senior Technical Writer | National Instruments | Austin, TX | Feb 2014–Dec 2023

- Authored API guides, hardware specifications, and reference content for complex test and measurement software and hardware platforms used in automotive and research industries.
- Updated hardware specifications and revamped the PXIe-4322 user manual, securing stakeholder approval and enabling \$1.5M in customer order fulfillment.
- Migrated product documentation and build components from Perforce to Git, integrating with a developer-focused toolchain including Jira, Confluence, and Microsoft Azure DevOps.
- Established a cross-team documentation review process spanning software development, hardware calibration, and compliance reviewers across global locations.
- Documented beta releases that drove customer sales and facilitated marketing of automotive test solutions, resulting in measurable reductions in support calls.
- Led monthly cross-functional meetings with Metrology, Calibration, and Technical Communication departments to prioritize projects, resolve issues, and ensure alignment.

Information Developer | HP TippingPoint (Contract) | Austin, TX | Jan 2013–Feb 2014

- Documented HP TippingPoint's first Next-Generation Firewall system, a complex enterprise security platform.
- Collaborated with HP's UX team to ensure efficient process flow and product usability; championed documentation concerns in Agile product scrums.
- Mentored new writers, training them on processes, tools, and best practices; led writers through training and certifications in HPE network security solutions.

Technical Writer | AMD (Contract) | Austin, TX | Nov 2011–Dec 2012

- Analyzed processor design and reference guides, organized content into book-level DITA maps, and coded XML for FrameMaker-to-DITA document conversions.

- Trained a team of 10 writers on using Oxygen Author, DITA conditional processing, SVN, and Alfresco CMS to create, edit, and curate documentation.
- Streamlined DITA conversion, authoring, and documentation production processes using a new toolchain and customized scripts.

Technical Writer | Reddwerks | Austin, TX | Nov 2010–Nov 2011

- Provided hands-on user training to 20 warehouse workers on the supply chain picking system and wearable computer software features.
- Developed training manuals and user documentation for warehouse order fulfillment system.

Technical Writer | TippingPoint (Multiple Contracts) | Austin, TX | Mar 2010–Nov 2010

Technical Writer | National Instruments (Contract) | Austin, TX | Feb 2009–Mar 2010

Information Developer | IBM | Austin, TX | Jun 2000–Feb 2009

- Developed content for installation and administration guides, developer references, API guides, release notes, and online help for enterprise network security software.
- Adapted documentation processes for Agile software development, assimilating information from scrums and project wikis.
- Contributed to IBM Redbooks publication, *e-Technology Center e-ESM 6.1 in a Shared Environment*.

CORE COMPETENCIES

<i>API & Developer Docs</i>	OpenAPI/Swagger, REST API documentation, integration guides, developer documentation, release notes, SDK-related content
<i>Docs-as-Code</i>	Git, GitHub, Azure DevOps, Markdown, Confluence, Jira, CMS, version control
<i>Technical Writing</i>	Structured authoring, information architecture, DITA/XML, HTML, FrameMaker, Adobe Creative Suite, Oxygen Author, XMetaL
<i>Engineering Fluency</i>	JavaScript, Python, Java, C++, Git, Perforce, SVN, Visual Studio, VMware, API specifications
<i>Collaboration & Agile</i>	Cross-functional SME collaboration, Agile/Scrum methodology, global distributed team coordination, mentoring

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

M.A. in English	B.S. in English
Texas A&M University College Station, TX	Ball State University Muncie, IN

Ongoing Professional Development (2024—Present)

Completed coursework in API design, REST API, generative AI, and cloud architecture to deepen domain expertise and stay current with evolving doc technologies and developer toolchains.

Selected Certifications & Coursework

API Documentation, Designing & Planning RESTful APIs, Generative AI & Prompt Engineering, Agentic AI Fundamentals, Git & GitHub, Cloud Computing, JavaScript, Java, OpenAPI/JSON, XML/XSLT

Recent Projects

[Portfolio Site](#) (2025): Built and deployed a portfolio site using Docusaurus, React, and Markdown, hosted on GitHub Pages.

[Instruments API](#) (2025): Designed and documented a mock REST API. Validated and tested CRUD operations using Postman, including GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE. Managed project files and documentation using a Git-based, Docs-as-Code workflow.

[AI-Assisted CRM Lead Follow-Up Workflow](#) (2026): Developed a workflow specification to document the design, API behavior, and AI governance requirements for an AI-assisted lead follow-up system within a Customer Relationship Management (CRM) platform.